

1. Introduction

Hello, thank you for taking the time to talk with us today! We greatly appreciate your participation in this study. For this interview, I'm going to be reading off of a protocol script per our research procedure. Also, I'm not sure if this call will take that long, but Zoom has a limit of 40 minutes per meeting for the free plan, so if we need to go over 40 minutes, could I ask you to rejoin the meeting?

[Get confirmation]

To give some background, my colleagues and I are working on this research study for Virginia Commonwealth University to see what open source contributors think of our current newsletter, which uses a Large Language Model to summarize all of the changes to a GitHub project on a weekly basis. The purpose of this Zoom meeting is to explain our study and to show you our current newsletter prototype that we generated for your open source project [repository].

If you have any questions about this study following this Zoom call, please contact me by email.

I'll put this in the chat.

[Put email in the chat]

Now the first part of this Zoom call is going to be us asking just a few questions about your experience as an open source contributor. It's not meant to be tricky or stressful or anything so

don't worry. The second part of this Zoom call will be us giving you a link to a newsletter that we generated for your specific open source project, and we're going to ask you to share your thoughts aloud as you review its design and content for the first time to get your feedback.

We expect this entire call to take around 30 to 45 minutes. Your responses will be kept completely confidential and anonymous, and all responses will be de-identified so we cannot tell what feedback was given by whom. Your name, email, and personal identifying information will NOT be included in any published documents.

Before we begin, I would like to record the audio of this interview for internal notetaking and analysis. Only members of our research team will have access to these recordings and their transcripts. Is that OK with you?

[Get confirmation]

[If they say no, do not record audio]

We would also like to record the video of this interview for internal notetaking and analysis as well. These recordings will also only be accessible by members of our research team. Is that okay with you?

[Get confirmation]

[If they say yes, begin recording video]

2. Background Information / General Questions:

Now, with the introduction out of the way, I would like to move into some background questions.

I was wondering if you could just give a bit about yourself and what you do professionally.

[Get their response]

To get a bit of background on your repository, what is [repository] and how do you contribute to it?

[Get their response]

What is your current way of keeping up to date with what goes on in the repository? Like do you go through all of the issues and all of the commits or anything?

[Get their response]

What are some important components of an open source GitHub repository that you care about when you contribute to it? Like for example, pull requests and issues or anything.

[Get their response]

How important would you say ‘toxicity in discussions’ is in your open source project? Like how frequently or big of a concern is it if a conversation gets heated in a GitHub issue, for example.

[Get their response]

3. Newsletter Discussion (Think Aloud)

Now, we’re going to move into the second part of the Zoom call. I’m going to put in the chat a link to the newsletter that we created for [repository]. I just want you to think aloud while looking through the design and content for now. There are no right or wrong answers, but we want to just observe your thought process as you interact with the newsletter. Keep in mind that you are NOT expected to read everything because it’s a long newsletter. We’re just asking you to share your thoughts on it aloud.

[Add the newsletter to the chat]

I would also like to ask if you could share your screen so we can see what part of the newsletter you are looking at, but it is completely up to you if you prefer not to do that.

Also, keep in mind that you are allowed to ask questions about parts of the newsletter, but we are NOT going to answer any questions during this section. Just say anything and everything that comes to your mind. You are allowed to be as overtly critical as you’d like. I know it may seem

unnatural, but it is very important that you continue to talk as you're moving through the newsletter.

Let me know when you have opened the newsletter and have started looking at it.

4. Post Think Aloud Discussion Questions

Thank you for taking time to think aloud through the newsletter. Now, we would like to ask a few post-Think-Aloud questions.

Which sections of the newsletter did you find most important?

[Get their response]

What things would you like to see added to the newsletter that were not present in it?

[Get their response]

What things would you like to see removed from or clarified in the newsletter?

[Get their response]

Did you get a good sense of the project's progress and/or wellbeing?

[Get their response]

Do you think sending out a newsletter weekly is okay, such as every Monday at 8 am? Or do you think it would be more useful sent out daily, monthly, biweekly?

[Get their response]

5. Conclusion

This concludes the end of everything that we would like to discuss in this meeting. Thank you so much again for your time, participation, and feedback in this study, and as promised, you will be compensated with a \$50 Amazon gift card in an email after this meeting. Do you have any final thoughts or questions before we wrap up?

[Answer any questions]

We truly appreciate your participation in this study, and have a great rest of your day!

[Stop recording]